

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9  
♥ A Q 9 3  
♦ K 8 7 5  
♣ J 6 5

♠ K J 10 8 2

♥ 10 4

♦ 3

♣ Q 10 9 7 2



♠ Q 7 6 4

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 2

♣ A 8 4 3

♠ 5 3

♥ K 8 6 5

♦ A Q J 10 6 4

♣ K

The bidding has been as shown. It is your turn.

Decide what you would say, then click on "" above.

You have 14 points but so what. You have no 5-card suit to Overcall. You cannot make a Takeout Double with 4 of their suit. So you pass. It is important to realize that there are hands you would open but cannot overcall with.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♦

All Pass

1 ♦ by South

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 8 6 4  
♥ 4  
♦ 10 5  
♣ K 10 9 4 2

♠ A 7 5 3  
♥ K 10 9 3  
♦ K 9 6 4  
♣ 5



♠ K  
♥ 8 6 2  
♦ A 8 3 2  
♣ A Q J 7 3

♠ 10 9 2  
♥ A Q J 7 5  
♦ Q J 7  
♣ 8 6

The bidding has been as shown.

With four trumps and 12 points you have a text-book raise to 3♥. Partner had a minimum overcall though, so he passed.

| <i>West</i> | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|-------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|             |              | 1♣          | 1♥           |
| Pass        | 3♥           |             |              |
| All Pass    |              |             |              |
| 3♥ by South |              |             |              |

**Board 3**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 6 5 2  
♥ 10 6 4  
♦ 10 9 2  
♣ J 7

♠ A 7 4 3

♥ K 8 3

♦ 6 3

♣ 9 8 4 3



♠ Q J

♥ 9 2

♦ K Q J 4

♣ A K Q 10 2

♠ 10 9

♥ A Q J 7 5

♦ A 8 7 5

♣ 6 5

The bidding has been as shown.

With 12 points and a good suit you have a very solid overcall so you bid 1♥. Partner responds 2♥.

Partner is showing 6-10 points and three trumps. Your hand revalues to 14 at most so you pass.

*West**North**East**South*

1♣

1♥

Pass

2♥

All Pass

2♥ by South

**Board 4**

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 8 5 4 3 2

♥ Q 7 6

♦ J 3

♣ J 10

♠ 6

♥ K J 9 4 3

♦ K 9 4

♣ 8 7 6 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A

♥ A 10 5 2

♦ A 10 8 7 5

♣ A K 2

♠ K Q J 9 7

♥ 8

♦ Q 6 2

♣ Q 9 4 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♦

1 ♠

All Pass

1 ♠ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

You really don't like partner's ♠s, and you do have 8 points. But 8 points is not enough to be considering game, and you would have to bid your ♥s at the 2-level. All things considered it is better to pass while you still aren't doubled.

**Board 5**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 3  
♥ 4  
♦ K 9 8 6 4 3  
♣ K Q 9 7

♠ J 7 5 2

♥ A 8 6 3

♦ A 10 2

♣ 10 3



♠ A K 8 6 4

♥ 10 9

♦ 5

♣ A J 8 4 2

♠ 10 9

♥ K Q J 7 5 2

♦ Q J 7

♣ 6 5

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by South

1♠

2♥

The bidding has been as shown.

You overcall 2♥ and hear partner raise you to 3♥.

No matter how many times you check this hand you cannot revalue it any more than 13 points. Since partner has 10 at the most you reluctantly pass.

**Board 6**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 4  
♥ Q 6 5  
♦ K J 6 2  
♣ J 6 5 4

♠ J 8 3

♥ A J 9 2

♦ 10 7

♣ 9 8 3 2



♠ Q 6 2

♥ 8 7 4

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ A Q 10

♠ A K 9 7 5

♥ K 10 3

♦ 9 5 3

♣ K 7

The bidding has been as shown.

With only 7 points you might not think you have enough to make a "free bid". But in competitive bidding situations like these, where both sides have a fit, bidding is usually better than passing. So you bid 2♠.

You might look at the Law of Total Tricks lesson for more on this subject.

*West**North**East**South*

2♦

2♠

1♦

1♠

All Pass

2♠ by South

**Board 7**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5  
♥ 10 7 6 2  
♦ K J 9 2  
♣ A J 6

♠ K 8 4 2

♥ A 9 3

♦ 10 5

♣ K Q 9 3



♠ A 7

♥ J 8 5

♦ A Q 7 4

♣ 10 7 5 4

♠ Q J 10 9 3

♥ K Q 4

♦ 8 6 3

♣ 8 2

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

You have enough for a 1-level Overcall so you bid 1♠. Partner says 3♠.

The jump raise tells you partner has 11-14 points.

With your minimum it's going to have to be better than that to get you excited. So you pass.

**Board 8**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 2  
 ♥ J 10 6 4  
 ♦ K Q 10 7 4  
 ♣ 10 6

♠ K 8 7 5 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A

♣ 7 5 4 3



♠ 10  
 ♥ A K Q 9 8  
 ♦ J 5 3  
 ♣ A K Q 9

♠ A Q J 6 4

♥ 3

♦ 9 8 6 2

♣ J 8 2

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

4♠

1♥

1♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

You have 10 points, but in cases like this points don't matter that much. They **MIGHT** be able to make 4♥. Partner **MIGHT** be able to make 4♠. This preemptive jump takes the decision away from them.

Looking at the hands you can see that partner is going to go down 1 at 4♠. However, that is an excellent result since they appear to be cold for 5♥.



**Board 9**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 2  
 ♥ J 6 2  
 ♦ J 8 7 2  
 ♣ Q 8 3

♠ A J 7 6

♥ Q 9 7 3

♦ A 5 4

♣ 9 2



♠ K Q 10 4

♥ 5

♦ Q 10 9

♣ K J 10 7 6

♠ 5 3

♥ A K 10 8 4

♦ K 6 3

♣ A 5 4

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

1 ♥

Pass

3 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

Nice hand. But not nice enough to double, then bid your ♥s. So you overcall 1 ♥. Partner says 3 ♥.

The jump raise promises 11-14 points. Your 17 plus partner's 11 or so takes you right up to game. You bid 4 ♥.

**Board 10**

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 8 6 3  
♥ A 7 6 4  
♦ K Q  
♣ 10 6

♠ 7 2

♥ Q 8

♦ J 5 2

♣ A K J 9 7 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ J 10 4

♥ J 9 3

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ 8 5 4

♠ A K 5

♥ K 10 5 2

♦ 10 9 7 4

♣ Q 3

*West*

1 ♠

Pass

All Pass

3NT by South

*North*

2 ♣

3NT

*East*

Pass

*South*

2NT

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner has at least 11 points for his 2-level overcall. He might have as many as 16. You have a perfect invitational hand including two sure stoppers in their suit. So you bid 2NT. Partner raises to 3NT and you get to play it there.

**Board 11**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 7 5  
♥ 7 3 2  
♦ 8 7 6 4 2  
♣ 7 6

♠ A 8 3 2  
♥ K J 10 6  
♦ J 9 3  
♣ 10 8

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ J 6 4  
♥ Q 9 5  
♦ K Q  
♣ A J 5 4 2

♠ K Q 9  
♥ A 8 4  
♦ A 10 5  
♣ K Q 9 3

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       | 1 ♣  | 1NT   |
| Pass         | 2 ♣   | Pass | 2 ♦   |
| Pass         | 2NT   | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |

The bidding has been as shown.

This hand would be one point too strong to **Open** 1NT, but it fits the 15-18 range to **Overcall** 1NT. Partner responds 2 ♣.

Don't get your systems crossed. Partner did not make a cue-bid, he is using Stayman. Since you have no 4-card Major suit you answer 2 ♦. Partner now says 2NT and the ball is in your court.

This is just a plain old 1NT/Stayman sequence. Partner is inviting, and since you have 18 points you accept.

**Board 12**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 4  
 ♥ 10 9 4 3  
 ♦ Q J 4 3  
 ♣ J 7 4 2

♠ Q 8 6 3  
 ♥ A K Q 7  
 ♦ 6 5  
 ♣ K 10 6



♠ J 9 2  
 ♥ 8 5 2  
 ♦ A K 10 8  
 ♣ A 9 5

♠ A K 10 7 5  
 ♥ J 6  
 ♦ 9 7 2  
 ♣ Q 8 3

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              |              | 1 ♦         | 1 ♠          |
| Pass         | 2 ♦          | Pass        | 2 ♠          |
| Pass         | 4 ♠          |             |              |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 4 ♠ by South |              |             |              |

The bidding has been as shown.

Wow! Great ♠ support and 15 points. You cue-bid 2 ♦, forcing partner to bid. He says 2 ♠. Your turn.

Partner has not made a strong bid and it is possible that 10 tricks will be too high. But it is pretty likely that game can be made so you bid it. Be bold!

**Board 13**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A 6 3 2

♥ 5

♦ A 10 7 4 2

♣ K 6 3

♠ 10 7

♥ K Q 6 2

♦ K 8 5

♣ 8 7 4 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 5

♥ A J 10 9 7 3

♦ J 9

♣ A Q J 10

♠ K Q J 9 8 4

♥ 8 4

♦ Q 6 3

♣ 9 5

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

2 ♠

All Pass

2 ♠ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

If you had been the dealer you would have opened 2 ♠. The situation is no different after they open so you Overcall 2 ♠. Everybody passes.

**Board 14**

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10  
 ♥ 5 4 2  
 ♦ K Q 7 4 2  
 ♣ A 9 4

♠ 9 7 5

♥ K Q J 9 7

♦ 8 3

♣ K 5 2



♠ 4 2

♥ A 10 8 6

♦ A J 10 9

♣ J 8 3

♠ A K J 8 6 3

♥ 3

♦ 6 5

♣ Q 10 7 6

*West*

1 ♦

Pass

All Pass

2 ♠ by South

*North*

1 ♥

2 ♠

*East*

Pass

*South*

1 ♠

The bidding has been as shown.

You don't like to take partner out of his overcalled suit without good reason. Here you have good reason. So you bid 1 ♠. Partner replies 2 ♠. What do you say next?

You expect partner to have three trumps, but he has made a minimum bid. So you take the conservative route and pass.

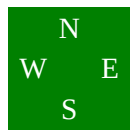
**Board 15**

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 2  
♥ 10 7 2  
♦ J 5  
♣ A Q J 7 6 3

♠ 10 8 5  
♥ A K J 8 4  
♦ K 6 3  
♣ 9 5



♠ 6 4  
♥ 9 6 5 3  
♦ Q 10 9 4  
♣ K 8 2

♠ K Q J 9 7 3  
♥ Q  
♦ A 8 7 2  
♣ 10 4

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| 1 ♣          | 1 ♥   | Pass | 1 ♠   |
| Pass         | 2 ♠   | Pass | 4 ♠   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 4 ♠ by South |       |      |       |

The bidding has been as shown.

You have a nice easy decision here. You overcall 1 ♥. Then partner bids 1 ♠. What do you say next?

Whether you play a change of suit as forcing or not, your hand certainly qualifies as one where you should make a bid. Partner doesn't really like your ♥s but you are quite satisfied to play in ♠s. So you bid 2 ♠. Partner jumps to 4 ♠ and that closes out the auction.

**Board 16**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 2  
 ♥ 9 4 2  
 ♦ 9 7 4 3  
 ♣ K J 8 3

♠ K Q 8 3  
 ♥ A 8 6 5  
 ♦ 6 5  
 ♣ 10 7 6



♠ A 7 5 4  
 ♥ Q J  
 ♦ K Q 8 2  
 ♣ 9 4 2

♠ J 10 9  
 ♥ K 10 7 3  
 ♦ A J 10  
 ♣ A Q 5

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       | 1 ♦  | 1NT   |
| Pass         | 2 ♣   | Pass | 2 ♥   |
| Pass         | 3 ♥   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3 ♥ by South |       |      |       |

The bidding has been as shown.

You treat partner's 1NT Overcall the same as a 1NT Opening. You use Stayman and bid 2 ♣. Partner replies 2 ♥. What is your next bid?

You have 9 points, an invitational strength hand. You bid 3 ♥, inviting partner to go to game with a maximum. He declines your invitation.



**Board 17**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 6  
 ♥ 8 7 6 5 3  
 ♦ 10 8 7 4  
 ♣ 5

♠ 8 4

♥ K Q J

♦ A Q 9 5

♣ K 9 7 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ K 7 5 3 2

♥ A 2

♦ J 6 2

♣ A 8 4

♠ A J 9

♥ 10 9 4

♦ K 3

♣ Q J 10 6 3

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

2 ♣

Pass

2 ♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

The bidding has been as shown.

You have a sound 2-level overcall. You bid 2 ♣ and partner replies 2 ♠. What is your next bid?

Partner's cue-bid obviously forces you to bid.

Partner's hand might be very distributional, but rather than just sticking to ♣s you suggest with 2NT. This guarantees you have ♠s stopped. Partner likes your suggestion and bids 3NT.

**Board 18**

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 7 6  
♥ K 6 3  
♦ 10 5 4  
♣ A K 9 3

♠ K Q J 10 5

♥ Q 10 7

♦ A J 3

♣ 8 7



♠ 9 4 2  
♥ 8 5 4 2  
♦ 8 6 2  
♣ 5 4 2

♠ 8 3

♥ A J 9

♦ K Q 9 7

♣ Q J 10 6

The bidding has been as shown.

Balanced hand, poor support for partner's suit, stoppers in their suit and 13 points. You couldn't get a better hand to jump to 2NT. Partner takes you to 3NT.

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| 1 ♣          | 1 ♠   | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass         | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |

**Board 19**

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 6 5  
 ♥ A 9 6 2  
 ♦ 3  
 ♣ A J 8 5 3

♠ 8 3

♥ K 8 5

♦ K Q 10 9 6 4

♣ 7 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ Q 9 7 4 2

♥ J 4 3

♦ J 8 2

♣ 6 4

♠ A J 10

♥ Q 10 7

♦ A 7 5

♣ K Q 10 9

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| 1 ♣          | 2 ♦   | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass         | 3 ♥   | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |

The bidding has been as shown.

With a good 6-card suit and 10 points you make a Weak Jump Overcall to 2 ♦. Partner says 2NT.

The 2NT bid is a standard response to a Weak 2-bid. It asks for the identification of any outside high-card if the Weak 2-bidder has more than a minimum. Here you are in the top range for your bid so you show your ♥K.

That was apparently the missing link for partner, he now says 3NT.

**Board 20**

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6 4  
 ♥ J 10 9 6 3  
 ♦ Q 10 8 4  
 ♣ Q 7

♠ A 8 5

♥ A K 7

♦ K J 6

♣ 10 8 6 4



♠ J 7

♥ Q 5

♦ 9 5 3 2

♣ A K J 5 3

♠ K Q 10 9 3 2

♥ 8 4 2

♦ A 7

♣ 9 2

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       | 1♣   | 2♠    |
| Pass        | 2NT   | Pass | 3♦    |
| Pass        | 4♠    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♠ by South |       |      |       |

The bidding has been as shown.

You might just try 4♠. Of course if partner has a minimum Weak Jump Overcall that will get you much too high. A better approach is to ask for more information from partner. The bid that asks is 2NT. Partner replies 3♦.

Partner's 3♦ bid tells you two things. One, he is in the top half of his 6-11 point range. Two, he has a high card (Ace or King) in ♦s. When you construct a hand for him which contains 6 pretty good ♠s and the ♦A you come up with a hand which will probably make game. Bid 4♠.